

NAPCS Unionization Research — State — Charter School Overview

Florida — PERC (FL) Jurisdiction — May 2026

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Section 1: State Overview

State	Florida
Labor Board	PERC (FL) — Florida Public Employees Relations Commission
Governing Law	Florida Public Employees Relations Act (PERA), Fla. Stat. §447.203. PERC(FL) has exclusive jurisdiction over all FL charter schools — all are public employers. NLRB has no jurisdiction. SB256 (2023) requires annual union recertification if dues-paying membership falls below 60%.
Federal NLRB Jurisdiction	PERC (FL) has exclusive jurisdiction. Federal NLRB does not apply.
Right-to-Work	Right-to-Work State — Art. X §12, Florida Constitution (Florida is a right-to-work state by constitutional provision. Union security clauses (mandatory dues/fees) are not available for FL charter school unions. SB256 (2023) added annual recertification requirements for public-sector unions falling below 60% dues-paying membership. Right-to-work applies to PERC(FL)-jurisdiction charter schools as public employers and to any NLRB-jurisdiction charter schools as private employers.)
For-Profit Operator Status	For-profit EMO management contracts permitted under state law
Card-Check Available	NO — No card-check equivalent under PERA. Secret ballot election required. SB256 (2023) requires annual recertification if below 60% dues-paying membership. PERC(FL) portal accessible at perc.myflorida.com/co/certResults.aspx — union-name search methodology required.
Registry Sweep	COMPLETE — May 2026 (Registry v50 — PERC(FL) supplemental sweep May 16, 2026) — 730 charter schools searched
Research Window	May 3–16, 2026

Section 2: Charter School Landscape

Total charter schools in Florida: 730 (Charter School Registry v50 (NCES/ELSI 2024-25; 730 open FL charter schools as of May 2026)). Unionization census figures reflect confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

Category	Schools	% of Total	Notes
Total Organized Charter Schools in Florida	8	1.1%	CONFIRMED (4) + DEPENDENT (3). PERC(FL) exclusive jurisdiction (PERA, Fla. Stat. §447.203). 0 NLRB RC certifications across 768 FL registry schools. Denominator: 730 open FL charter schools (Registry v50). See charterUniverseNote in STATE_META re: 730 vs 734 discrepancy.
Independently Organized (CONFIRMED)	5	0.7%	City of Pembroke Pines Charter Schools (3 campuses) — BTU Local 1975/FEA, Jan 2007 (181-46 vote). Compass Middle Charter School (C1202008) — Polk Education Association/FEA, PERC Cert #1713/#1714/#1715,

			December 1, 2009, 3 bargaining units.
Structurally Covered — District CBAs (DEPENDENT)	3	0.4%	Academy of Environmental Science (CCEA/FEA, PERC Cert #1261/#473); Bellalago Charter Academy (OCEA/FEA, PERC Cert #1729/#18); Children's Reading Center (PFT/United/FEA, PERC Cert #635/#45). All district employers confirmed May 2026. Union names corrected from NAPCS baseline errors.
Closed / Transitioned (Not a Charter)	1	0.1%	Palm Pointe (C1208026) — transitioned from charter to St. Lucie County public school July 2024.
Total Charter Schools in Florida	730	100%	Source: Charter School Registry v50 (NCES/ELSI 2024-25). Registry v59 adds 4 additional schools; updated universe = 734 per Dashboard Audit v2.

Charter School Enrollment

Total Charter Enrollment	405,354 students — 14.2% of state K–12 enrollment (2,859,600 total K–12 students)
Students in CMO/EMO-Affiliated Charter Schools	168,181 students in network-affiliated schools — 41.5% of total charter enrollment
Students in Organized Charter Schools	10,338 students (2.6% of charter enrollment)
Data Sources	Charter enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 / Charter School Registry v133. Total K–12 state enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 (all public schools). Both figures from the same source and year.

Section 3: Charter Management Organizations & Education Management Organizations

Charter Management Organizations (CMOs) are nonprofit networks. Education Management Organizations (EMOs) are for-profit management companies. Data sourced from Charter School Registry v133. Union penetration reflects confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

CMO / EMO Name	Type	State Campuses	National Campuses †	Organized in State	Total Enrollment
Charter Schools USA Inc.	EMO	26	25	—	23,550
Somerset Academy Inc.	CMO	62	62	—	29,691
Mater Academy Inc.	CMO	38	40	—	24,600
Pinecrest Academy Inc.	CMO	22	24	—	12,803
BridgePrep Academy Inc.	CMO	19	20	—	9,876
Renaissance Charter School	CMO	19	19	—	20,241

Inc.					
Imagine Schools Inc.	CMO	13	14	—	10,585
Academir Charter Schools Inc.	CMO	11	11	—	4,251
Sports Leadership and Management Charter School Inc.	CMO	11	11	—	6,213
Doral Academy Inc.	CMO	9	11	—	8,527
Plato Academy Schools Corporation	CMO	7	7	—	3,011
National Ben Gamla Charter School Foundation Inc.	CMO	5	5	—	1,337
IDEA Public Schools	CMO	5	6	—	4,602
KIPP Miami Inc.	CMO	4	4	—	4,515
Archimedean Academy Inc.	CMO	3	3	—	1,278
Athenian Academy Inc.	CMO	3	3	—	1,218
Navigator Academy of Leadership	CMO	2	4	—	1,883
TOTAL — All CMO/EMO Schools in Florida		259		—	168,181
of which organized				—	—

Total enrollment shown is the combined enrollment of all CMO/EMO network schools in Florida. Organized network schools: 0 organized schools in network-affiliated charters.

† National Campuses reflects total campuses operated by this network across all states, as reported in Charter School Registry v133. Provides context for networks operating in multiple states.

‡ Network (type unclassified) = operator present in Charter School Registry v133 but not yet classified in CMO Reference data. Contact registry project to add classification for these records.

1 EMO (for-profit), 16 CMO (nonprofit). Approximately 471 schools operate independently with no CMO/EMO affiliation. Source: Charter School Registry v133.

Section 4: Legal Framework & Charter School Overview

Findings are based on research as of May 2026.

1: Legal & Jurisdictional Framework

Florida Public Employees Relations Act (PERA), Fla. Stat. §447.203. PERC(FL) has exclusive jurisdiction over all FL charter schools — all are public employers. NLRB has no jurisdiction. SB256 (2023) requires annual union recertification if dues-paying membership falls below 60%. Florida is a right-to-work state (Art. X §12, Florida Constitution). PERC (FL) has exclusive jurisdiction. Federal NLRB does not apply to charter schools in Florida. Secret ballot NLRB election is the required organizing pathway. Card-check is not available.

2: Charter School Structure

Florida operates 730 open-enrollment charter schools, enrolling approximately 405,354 students. 17 charter management organizations and education management organizations operate in Florida, including 1 for-profit EMO. The largest networks by campus count are Somerset Academy Inc. (62 campuses in state), Mater Academy Inc. (38 campuses in state), Charter Schools USA Inc. (26 campuses in state). Approximately 471 schools operate independently with no CMO or EMO affiliation. Network-level detail, including campus counts and total enrollment, appears in Section 3 above.

Section 5: Media Coverage & Public Stakeholder Positions

Press Coverage

Teachers in Fla. Charter Schools Vote to Join Local Union Affiliate — Education Week — January 30, 2007. Primary source for Pembroke Pines 2007 election: 181-46 vote, 7 campuses, first FL charter school network election. Palm Pointe Educational Research School at Tradition Transitions to St. Lucie Public Schools — WQCS (NPR Florida) — August 2023. Palm Pointe charter-to-public-school conversion announced for July 2024. Broward teachers vote to keep union amid tougher state rules — Caribbean National Weekly — July 15, 2025. BTU recertification election under SB256 (2023) — BTU won 6,228-128. Florida law pushes elections on teachers' collective bargaining in Broward, Miami-Dade — Local 10 / WPLG — September 1, 2024. SB256 recertification elections for BTU and United Teachers of Dade.

Section 6: Contract & CBA Access Registry

PERC (FL) public contracts portal. Direct PDF links may require a records request for full text.

School / Network	Union	CBA Status & Term	Contract Access
City of Pembroke Pines Charter School System (3 campuses: C1298003, C1200007, C1299007)	Broward Teachers Union (BTU) Local #1975 — Charter School Professionals Unit	Active — 2024-25 agreement 2024-25 (annual salary negotiations; current agreement reached 2024)	BTU Negotiations page (btuonline.com/negotiations/) — CBA summaries; direct link: http://www.ppines.com/DocumentCenter/View/2247/COMPARE-7-TO-12-Addendum for historical addendum